

30 years of the Lenovo ThinkPad

In conversation with Dilip Bhatia, Chief Customer Experience Officer and Vice President of User & Customer Experience, Lenovo to learn more about ThinkPad's 30-year-old legacy and the way forward

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Q A lot of things have changed regarding laptop form factors over the last 30 years. What were the unique design choices made over the course of the evolution of the ThinkPad laptops that made it stand apart from competition?

A ThinkPad fundamentally is very much tied to its users at the end of the day; it adapts with them. We have dived into a number of innovations across our 30 year history. When you go talk to a ThinkPad user and you say, if you had one word to talk about ThinkPad, what would it be? It is quality, it is reliability.

ThinkPad adapts with the times. During COVID, camera was a big issue, microphones were a big issue. And today, we have some of the best cameras, microphones in the marketplace. So it's always adapted to the needs of its users, but fundamentally core to what the ThinkPad is in terms of the quality, in terms of the reliability, in terms of the best keyboard in the marketplace.

Q So could you actually share like RMA figures for ThinkPad units versus other Lenovo lineups that speak to its durability and build quality?

A Yeah, Manish, I don't think we give out specific details, RMA figures. What I can



Dilip Bhatia
Chief Customer Experience Officer and
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tell you is it does very well overall. And a lot of it's, again, the quality management process that we have put in place across the board, the listening that we do when we design our products. And honestly, we wouldn't be number one in the commercial space, I wouldn't have shipped 200 million units as of October, if it wasn't for the quality and the reliability.

Q So another thing that's iconic about the ThinkPad is the pointing

stick, which you've decided to keep even now. One of the most iconic design aspects of the ThinkPad that has remained unchanged since. So what are the primary use cases of the TrackPoint in this day and age?

A We have a good segment of ThinkPad fans and followers that absolutely love the TrackPoint. I mean, I'll give you my own example, right? I personally love the TrackPoint because the nice thing about the TrackPoint is your fingers never have to leave the keyboard. I don't have to go back and forth to my trackpad. And so from an efficiency perspective, in terms of getting my work done, I'm personally a lot more efficient when I use the TrackPoint. And when we have talked to the users, they're like, don't even think about removing it. We love the TrackPoint and they wouldn't buy a ThinkPad if it wasn't for the TrackPoint. At the same time, we realise, there's a whole set of users that love the TrackPad and are very comfortable with it. So ThinkPad has to cater to all people, including people who love the TrackPad and the TrackPoint. But there's a huge fan following for the TrackPoint.

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